

Renewing Your Purpose

You may answer privately, in prayer, without writing everything down. Nothing here is graded or collected. No major decision is made on retreat: anything larger goes on a card marked "To test".

1 • Check-in

1. Did your main role once feel meaningful or life-giving? If so, what mattered about it then? If it never did, what originally led you into it?

2. Where has care become emotionally depleted or mechanically performed? Be specific: which tasks, which relationships, which parts of the role.

3. Who is presently within your legitimate sphere of care or responsibility? Who is not?

4. Honestly: if Jesus asked you "Do you love me?" today, what would you say? Write the true answer, including "I am not sure" if that is it. Do not turn this into a test of whether your feelings are intense or pure enough. In Scripture, love includes allegiance, trust, obedience, desire, and return, not uninterrupted emotional warmth. If this question leads you into repeated checking or fear, you may leave it unanswered and use the words, "Lord, you know everything."

3 • Silence

Fifteen minutes, or the length you can manage. "Lord, you know everything." Or, if it is honest today: "Lord, you know that I love you."

4 • Journal

1. What rose in the silence when the question was asked?

2. Is there a failure that you have treated as proof that grace, growth, or faithful participation are no longer possible? Write it down, and write what this passage says to it. Then, honestly: what restoration may be possible, and what roles may still remain inappropriate or require accountability?

3. Of the people within your care, where has care become depleted? What support, boundary, rest, or small act of attention might help you care more humanely this week?

4. Is any responsibility being sustained mainly by fear, approval-seeking, or the need to prove yourself? What other legitimate reasons remain? Most motives are mixed; mark it for discernment rather than judging it from motive alone.

5 • A purpose for this season

1. Who or what is genuinely within my care?
2. What is outside my responsibility?
3. What does love look like within my present capacity?
4. What support or boundary will make this sustainable?

Answer these briefly in your journal.

Cards to cut out

In this season, I want to practise love of God and neighbour by

within the limits and responsibilities I currently have.

One faithful thing:

To test (only if something larger surfaced)

6 • Closing declaration

Read only what you can say honestly. Adjust the words if you need to.

My purpose begins in relationship with Christ, not in proving my worth.

I will practise love within the responsibilities and limits of this season.

What has become unsustainable, I will bring into honest discernment.

I do not have to change the world.

I can take one faithful step.